1.2.2 Data warehouses and data lakes inside the data mesh

There is a misconception about the data mesh. It is sometimes perceived as an exclusive alternative to the central data lake or the central data warehouse. But that does not take into account what the data mesh is: a combination of two things, technology and organization. The data mesh is an alternative to having one centralized data unit taking care of the data inside central data storage.

That still leaves the option to have central data storage and decentralized units working and owning the data. Indeed, that is a common implementation in companies that don't need complete flexibility on the data producers' side. It also is a common approach to keep data lakes and data warehouses inside a business intelligence (BI) or data science team. The data lakes and data warehouses then become a node inside the data mesh. See figure 1.3.

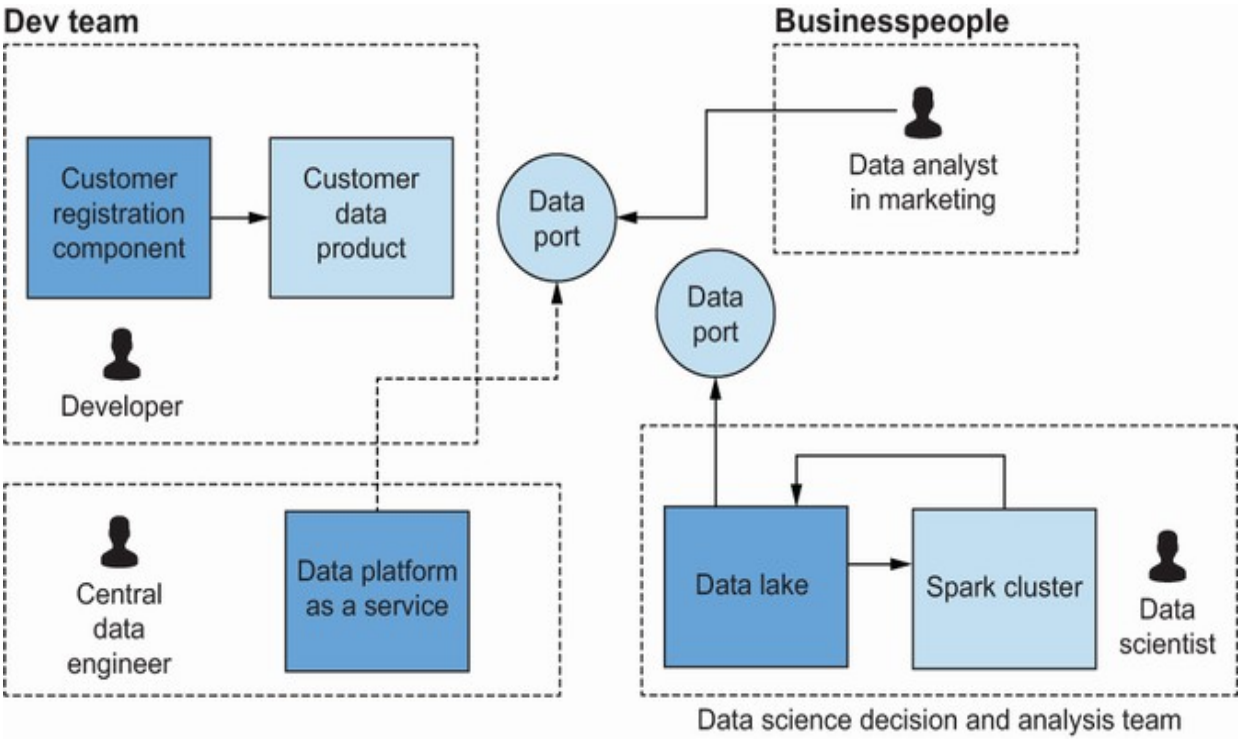


Figure 1.3 Data meshes can still use data lakes: for example, a data science team building data products may use data lakes as nodes within the data mesh.